# The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Heap of Flowers"

Āryapuṣpakūṭanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 886 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་མ་ཉེགོ་བར་སྡུས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་འཕགས་བྱང་།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Heap of Flowers," known in Sanskrit as the Āryapuṣpakūṭanāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Metok Tsekpa Zhejawé Zung, is a dhāraṇī text, a scripture centered on a sacred incantation believed to carry protective and spiritually transformative power. It opens with the Buddha dwelling at the great lake Anavatapta, in the palace of the nāga king of the same name. He is accompanied by five hundred monks and a thousand highly realized bodhisattvas gathered from other world systems, all of them masters of dhāraṇīs and meditative absorption who stand only one birth away from awakening. Within this setting the text presents its dhāraṇī and the benefits of upholding it. It is Toh 886 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī scriptures gathered in the canon's collections of incantations.

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In the language of India: ārya puṣpakūṭa nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Heap of Flowers."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at the great lake Anavatapta, in the palace of the nāga king Anavatapta, together with a great Saṅgha of five hundred monks. He was also together with a great assembly of bodhisattvas who had gathered from various other world systems, a full thousand bodhisattvas. All of them had obtained dhāraṇīs and obtained meditative absorption. They were bound to only one more birth and well established on the ten grounds. They had been empowered with the empowerment of regents who would succeed immediately. They had donned the great armor, and every one of them was free of doubt about all the qualities of a buddha.

At that time the bodhisattva, the great being Siṃhavikrīḍita, had come to that very assembly and was seated there. Then the bodhisattva, the great being Siṃhavikrīḍita, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, if a son or daughter of good family makes offerings to the Tathāgata, how much merit will that person generate?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva, the great being Siṃhavikrīḍita: "Siṃhavikrīḍita, do not say, 'Blessed One, if a son or daughter of good family makes offerings to the Tathāgata, how much merit will that person generate?' Why is that? The Tathāgata has immeasurable moral discipline, immeasurable meditative absorption, immeasurable wisdom, immeasurable liberation, and immeasurable seeing of the wisdom of liberation. Siṃhavikrīḍita, because the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, is endowed with an immeasurable mass of qualities, therefore one should know that the karmic maturation of making offerings to him is also immeasurable.

"Siṃhavikrīḍita, whether the Tathāgata is still present or has passed into complete nirvāṇa, all those who make offerings to him will pass into complete nirvāṇa by one of the three vehicles, namely the vehicle of the śrāvakas, the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, or the Great Vehicle.

"Furthermore, Siṃhavikrīḍita, there is one who sees the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, and gains faith, and with a faithful mind honors him with gifts, robes, food, bedding, medicines for illness, requisites, and every comfort, and venerates, honors, reveres, and serves him. And there is one who makes offerings to a stūpa holding a relic, no bigger than a mustard seed, of the Tathāgata who has passed into complete nirvāṇa. The karmic maturation of these two should be known to be equal. There is no distinction or difference between them.

"Siṃhavikrīḍita, suppose a householder bodhisattva were to offer as alms to śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas, a heap of jewels as large as Mount Meru. Compared with that, if a bodhisattva who has gone forth offers as alms as little as a single kārṣāpaṇa coin, and having offered it, fully dedicates it to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, the former root of virtue does not come near even a hundredth part of the latter root of virtue. It does not come near a thousandth part, a hundred-thousandth part, nor any number, fraction, calculation, comparison, or cause; it cannot even bear a simile.

"Siṃhavikrīḍita, there is one who serves the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, with every requisite of comfort, whether for one year, a hundred years, or a thousand years. And there are those who, fully embraced by the awakening mind, in order to honor the Tathāgata, offer a few flowers at the stūpa of the Tathāgata who has passed into complete nirvāṇa,

or sprinkle as much as a handful of water, or draw a dot of unguent, or sweep away withered flowers, or offer unguent, or offer perfume, or offer flowers, or offer incense, or offer garlands, or offer the music of cymbals, or offer a parasol, or offer a bell, or offer song, or offer a victory banner, or offer a flag, or offer silk, or offer a lamp, and having offered it, with a joyful mind take a few dancing steps and say, 'Homage to that Buddha, the Blessed One.' Siṃhavikrīḍita, there is no possibility that they will fall into the lower realms and the inferior states, not for an eon, nor for a hundred eons, nor for a thousand eons, nor even for a hundred thousand eons. One should have no doubt, hesitation, or uncertainty about this.

"Siṃhavikrīḍita, there is a dhāraṇī called Heap of Flowers. For the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude of gods and humans, I shall explain it.

"Siṃhavikrīḍita, whoever takes up this Heap of Flowers dhāraṇī, keeps it, reads it, brings it to mind, masters it, or teaches it extensively and correctly to others will always remember his past lives. He will not fall into the lower realms and the inferior states. He will find the state of leisure. He will never be separated from the Three Jewels. He will never be separated from the Tathāgata. He will never be separated from the recollection of the Buddha. He will never be separated from bodhisattvas. He will never be separated from the awakening mind. He will never have impaired faculties. He will never be born into a low caste. He will be richly endowed with varied and profound eloquence. He will see the buddhas, the blessed ones, of countless world systems in the ten directions.

tadyathā dhāraṇī dhāraṇī muniprabhasvare siddhe caṇḍe nāmaci nirhiri arogavati buddhamati dhairye oṃkarate gagarate rājāvati tejovati vipulabuddhe dharma avabhāse akṣayakalbe kalpavati amṛtakalbe hūtāśane tejovati niryasihite tejograbhā tiṣthi nadraya tiṣṭhī nadraye buddhi svāhā

Siṃhavikrīḍita, whoever knows the name, the letters, and all the words of this Heap of Flowers dhāraṇī, and has mastered it completely, should cultivate the recollection of the Buddha from the eighth to the fifteenth day of the waxing fortnight of the last month of spring, the first month of summer, and the last month of autumn. Contemplating three times by day and three times by night, he should bring the Tathāgata to mind single-pointedly. If he then makes offerings to the Blessed One of perfumes, flowers, lamps, and incense, he will

see fifteen buddhas, blessed ones, seated on lion thrones within the hearts of lotuses and teaching the Dharma.

He will fully attain dhāraṇī. He will be endowed with mindfulness. He will be endowed with intelligence. He will be endowed with realization. He will be endowed with understanding. Until he passes into complete nirvāṇa, he will remember his past lives. He will thoroughly know all that is heard, all treatises, all crafts, and all kinds of work. All meditative absorptions, too, will become completely pure within his mind, with the exception of the Four Noble Truths. Why is that? Because those dharmas belong to the undefiled.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva, the great being Siṃhavikrīḍita, those bodhisattvas, those monks, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called Heap of Flowers.

## Translator's Notes

• The term rendered "song" (dbyangs pa) among the offerings is uncertain. It may denote a melodious offering, or possibly a kind of streamer. The phrase rendered "cause" in the list of comparisons (rgyu, following bskrun pa, "comparison") follows the standard Sanskrit formula ending in upaniṣad.
• In the Tibetan, the number fifteen comes after "teaching the Dharma." It might instead refer back to the fifteenth day of the practice period, giving "on the fifteenth he will see the buddhas." The more literal reading has been followed.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.